

German Tank Destroyers (cont.)

Lacking complicated and expensive turrets, tank destroyers were quicker and cheaper to manufacture than conventional tanks. They could usually mount a more powerful gun on the same hull, and as the Germans retreated in the face of overwhelming Allied numbers and firepower, this became a distinct advantage. Later Jagdpanzers were fully armored and generally based on heavy tank hulls. In the last months of the war, tank destroyers increasingly began to take the place of actual tanks.

▷ Nashorn (Hornisse)
Date 1943 Country Germany
Weight 26.9 tons (24.4 tonnes)
Engine Maybach HL120TRM gasoline, 300 hp
Main armament 8.8 cm PaK 43/1 L/71 gun

The Nashorn was an interim design that used a chassis developed from the Panzer IV. It was later renamed Hornisse, and was the first German tank destroyer to mount the highly effective PaK 43 gun. The gun's very long range allowed the vehicle to stand off from the enemy.



Augmented Panzer IV chassis

7.5 cm StuK 40 gun



△ StuG IV
Date 1944 Country Germany
Weight 25.8 tons (23.4 tonnes)
Engine Maybach HL120TRM gasoline, 300 hp
Main armament 7.5 cm StuK 40 L/48

High demand for the StuG III meant that after a bombing raid on the factory, the Germans adapted the design for the Panzer IV chassis in order to maintain production. Around 1,140 Stug IVs were built. Both variants proved highly effective as defensive antitank vehicles.

Modified PaK 43 gun



△ Ferdinand
Date 1943 Country Germany
Weight 72.8 tons (66 tonnes)
Engine 2 x Maybach HL 120TRM petrol, 300hp each
Main armament 8.8 cm PaK 43/2 L/71 gun

The Ferdinand hull was an unsuccessful design for the Tiger tank. A total of 90 tanks were built, and they were equipped with the PaK 43 in a fully enclosed and very heavily armored superstructure. The firepower and armor served them well as antitank platforms, but their huge size and weight restricted their mobility.

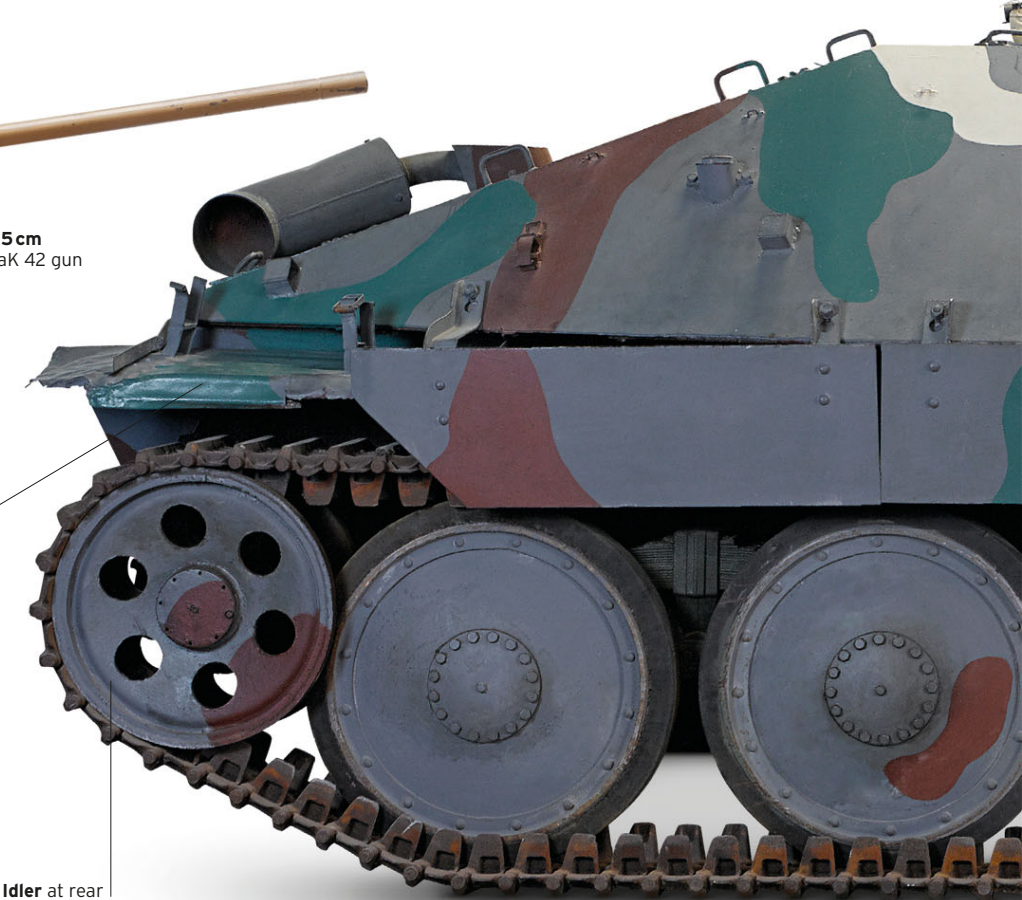
7.5 cm PaK 42 gun



△ Jagdpanzer IV/70
Date 1944 Country Germany
Weight 26.9 tons (24.4 tonnes)
Engine Maybach HL120TRM gasoline, 300 hp
Main armament 7.5cm PaK 42 L/70 gun

Like the StuG IV, the Jagdpanzer IV was also based on the Panzer IV chassis. A total of 769 of the original vehicle were built. A dedicated tank hunter, it was armed with a PaK 39 L/48 gun. This version was equipped with the longer and more powerful PaK 42 L/70, and replaced the earlier vehicle from 1944. Around 1,200 of these tanks were built.

Hull based on Panzer 38(t)



Idler at rear